

VA _ 28-9-2026

Directions for question 1: In the following sentence, a part of the sentence is underlined.

Beneath the sentence, four different ways of phrasing the underlined part are indicated. Choose the best alternative and mark the letter corresponding with it as your answer.

Since the 1990s, politicians and pundits predicted the imminent arrival of a digital utopia wherein robots would do the washing up and we would live in peace and harmony in an electronically connected global village – thanks to the net.

☒ a) pundits had predicted the imminent arrival of a digital utopia wherein (Your answer - ✖)

☐ b) pundits have predicted the imminent arrival of a digital utopia where

☐ c) pundits have predicted the imminent arrival of a digital utopia in which (Correct Answer - ✔)

☐ d) pundits predicted the imminent arrival of a digital utopia in which

Solution:

The present perfect 'have predicted' is appropriate with the time reference 'since the 1990s'. The underlined part refers to a 'digital utopia' – 'in which' or 'wherein' are both correct but 'where' in choice (B) is incorrect.
Choice (C)

Directions for question 2: Choose the best answer for the following question based on the information given in the passage.

Indian GDP growth has averaged 8% for four years. Indeed, it has crossed 9% in the first half of this fiscal year. The updated BRK report of Goldman Sach claims that India can sustain 8% growth for over a decade. A few years ago, India seemed stuck in a growth groove of 6% per year. Many analysts said it could not accelerate without much more reform. However, despite few new reforms, growth is up at 8%. Is this just a cyclical upswing, with India riding a global wave that will soon ebb? Or has something changed fundamentally?

Which of the following lends credence to the cyclical theory?

- ☐ a) The cumulative effects of reforms have finally reached a critical mass and exploded into much faster growth.
- ☐ b) Bank reforms have liberalized interest rates, slashed non-performing loans and helped banks move towards Basel-II norms.
- ☐ c) Indian growth of 8% is still only 2.5% higher than Africa's, the same as in earlier times.
- ☐ d) Agricultural barriers have been eroded, if not abolished, in many states paving the way for corporates to buy produce directly from farmers, cutting out intermediaries and creating a retail revolution.

Solution:

While all the options refer to reforms that have brought fundamental changes, only option (C) points to the fact that the growth with respect to that in Africa has remained unchanged – in other words, the growth is due to a global wave and hence cyclical.
Choice (C)

Directions for question 3: Find the odd man out.

☐ a) massive

☐ b) large

☒ c) monumental (Your answer - ✖)

☐ d) astronomical

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Solution:

While 'large' also conveys something big it does not suggest the mammoth size suggested by the other words.
Choice (B)

Directions for questions 4 to 6: The sentences given in each of the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is indicated with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and mark the correct sequence in the box provided below each question.

1. Previous studies have suggested that childhood trauma increases a person's risk of developing heart disease, diabetes and other disorders normally associated with obesity in adulthood.
2. They also found that childhood stress induces abnormal levels of inflammation, which has strong repercussions in adulthood.
3. This is much stronger and definitive than simply saying that people who have a hard time in childhood are more miserable and depressed as adults.
4. Childhood abuse has long been suspected of increasing a person's risk of developing disease later in life.
5. Now researchers studying inflammation in the bloodstream think they might know why.

4. Childhood abuse has long been suspected of increasing a person's risk of developing disease later in life.
5. Now researchers studying inflammation in the bloodstream think they might know why.
6. Modern researchers found that people who reported having been physically or sexually abused, or rejected by their mother at a young age, were likely to contain high levels of C-reactive protein, which is a marker of inflammation and has been linked to heart disease, in their blood.

Your Answer: 412365 ✖

Correct Answer: 451623 ✔

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PREVIOUS

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Solution:

'4' introduces the topic. '5' follows by saying that researchers now know why childhood abuse is linked to disease development. '1' brings out the results of previous studies – that childhood trauma is linked to heart disease. '6' then explains why people who have undergone childhood abuse are more likely to develop heart disease. '2' further supports it and '3' concludes that this is a more definitive way of explaining things. Hence we have 451623.
Ans : (451623)

Directions for questions 4 to 6: The sentences given in each of the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is indicated with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and mark the correct sequence in the box provided below each question.

1. But more varied in its contents of expression is the despair that follows.
2. This is especially so if the journey from home has no return ticket – be it wives from south Indian villages who travel with their husbands to the urban wilderness of Delhi or Mumbai, or husbands who spend their married lives as lonesome men working in the Gulf, or young students who leave the comfort of their homes for the sprawling university campuses of America or Australia.
3. Hope that a better future awaits.
4. From women deceived and trafficked across the world to high-skilled immigrants, a silver of promise animates many such decisions to move.
5. To leave one's home voluntarily for another place is a choice pregnant with twin sentiments: hope and despair.

Solution:

Only statement 5 can begin the paragraph, as all the other sentences do not make sense unless preceded by an earlier statement. Statement 3, follows 5 by mentioning about "hope", the first of the two sentiments mooted in 5. "A silver of promise", mentioned in 4 is a continuation of "hope" discussed in 3. 1 carries the discussion forward by mentioning about the next of the twin sentiments – "despair". 2 further elaborates on despair mentioned in 1. Therefore, the appropriate sequence is 53412. Ans : (53412)

Directions for questions 4 to 6: The sentences given in each of the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is indicated with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and mark the correct sequence in the box provided below each question.

1. Opposing groups fight for control of the country's natural resources and use the proceeds to buy weapons in times of uncertainty,
2. Tensions have been rising in Congo since December, when president Joseph Kabila postponed the elections.
3. Conflict is never far away in the Democratic Republic of Congo – a country rich in natural resources such as gold, diamonds, coltan and tin – and the country is on the brink of a new civil war.
4. As the situation gets worse, analysts point to the role of mining in the conflicts.
5. And all that is very bad news for the DRC's precious wildernesses.

Solution:

Statement 3 begins the paragraph by taking about the recurring conflicts in the Democratic Republic of Congo. 2 carries forward what is stated in 3 by saying that rising tensions in Congo have resulted in the postponement of elections. 4 follows 2 by mentioning what the analysts perceive to be the cause of the conflicts – the role of mining. 1, which elaborates on the role of mining, is a continuation of 4. 5, which states that all this is detrimental for Congo's wilderness, is conclusive in nature. Thus, the appropriate sequence is 32415. Ans : (32415)

Directions for questions 7 to 9: Each of the following questions presents 5 statements of which 4, when placed in appropriate order would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick the statement that is not part of that context and mark the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

1. In the wake of hurricane Irma, we are reminded that the effects of natural disasters are never entirely natural.
2. Following the impact of hurricane Irma, much debate has centered on the scope of aid Britain should provide to the Caribbean.
3. In the 19th century, when the Caribbean was ravaged by hurricanes, there was debate, but of quite a different nature.
4. The wrangling over the scope of relief could take years to resolve.
5. Relief was never a given and a justifiable case for relief had to be made to a Parliament wary of the Caribbean planters deliberately over estimating their losses.

Solution:

The passage talks about the aid which should be provided to the victims of hurricanes in the Caribbean. Statement 2 begins the topic by talking about a more recent event – the debate over the scope of aid that Britain should provide to the Caribbean, in the wake of hurricane Irma. 3 follows 2 by stating that there was a debate even in the 19th century, when the Caribbean was ravaged by hurricanes, but the debate was of a different nature. 5 follows 3 by explaining what was the nature of debate which took place in the 19th century over the scope of relief that should be provided. “The wrangling” in 4 refers to the debate which took place in the 19th century, referred to in 5. Therefore, 4 concludes with the statement that the debate over the scope of relief would take years to resolve. Hence, 2,3,5,4 form a logical sequence and 1, which conveys a different idea – the effects of natural disasters, is not a part of the sequence 2,3,5,4.

Ans : (1)

Directions for questions 7 to 9: Each of the following questions presents 5 statements of which 4, when placed in appropriate order would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick the statement that is not part of that context and mark the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

1. Despite having millions of dollars lavished upon it by the United States, the Iraqi army almost collapsed in 2014 when it was attacked by the enemy.
2. European powers could not colonise the world without the support of indigenous peoples.
3. Today, with ISIS on the brink of defeat, attempts are being made to rebuild Iraq's armed forces.
4. The failure was attributed to a selfishly sectarian government in Baghdad.
5. Some Sunni personnel even defected to the Islamic State.

Your Answer: 2 ✓

Directions for questions 7 to 9: Each of the following questions presents 5 statements of which 4, when placed in appropriate order would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick the statement that is not part of that context and mark the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

1. The virus was first isolated from a rhesus monkey in Uganda in the Zika forest, near the western shore of Lake Victoria, in 1947, and hence the name.
2. A year after the WHO declared Zika a public emergency, there has been some positive news on the vaccine front.
3. Zika is an arbovirus infection which occurs through the bite of several different species of Aedes mosquitoes, including the Aedes aegypti which is active during the day.
4. But in 2007, more than a hundred cases were reported at Yap, a tiny island in the south-western Pacific.
5. The mosquito-borne virus spread in many African and Asian countries but caused no harm.

Solution:

Statement 3, which states the main topic of discussion – the Zika infection and how it is caused, is the opening statement of the paragraph. 1, which mentions how the disease got its name, is a continuation of 3. Further, “The virus” in 1, refers to the “arbovirus” which is responsible for causing the infection, mentioned in 3. 5, which talks about the spread of the disease in many Asian and African countries and mentions that the disease caused no harm despite its spread, is a continuation of 1. 4 follows 5 stating that the disease acquired virulence in 2007 by spreading rapidly. Therefore, 3,1,5,4 is the logical sequence. 2, which talks about a vaccine for Zika, can begin a different paragraph, but cannot form a part of the given sequence.

Ans : (2)

Directions for questions 10 and 11: The following questions have a paragraph from which the last sentence has been omitted. From the given options, choose the one that completes the paragraph in the most appropriate way.

We the Citizens, a non-governmental organisation, has filed a petition in the Supreme Court to scrap Article 35A. Article 35A was extended to Jammu and Kashmir through the Constitutional (Application to Jammu and Kashmir) Order issued by President Rajendra Prasad on May 14, 1954. It was specifically devised to grant protection to State subject laws that had already been defined under the Maharaja’s rule and notified in 1927 and 1932. Only state subjects are entitled to own land in both parts of the State divided by the Line of Control (LoC), that is, including PoK. However, in Gilgit-Baltistan, which has been almost annexed by Pakistan, people do not have State subject rights any longer. _____

- ☐ a) Article 35A is the provision of the Constitution that safeguards several rights available to the permanent residents of Jammu and Kashmir.

☒ b) This gives meat to the clamour for abrogation of Article 35A. (Correct Answer - ✓)

- ☐ c) The legal challenge to Article 35A, which protects the demographic composition of Jammu and Kashmir, has brought all sides of the political spectrum, barring the BJP, together.

☒ d) Tampering with the Article has the potential of setting the Valley ablaze again. (Your answer - ✗)

Solution:

Article 35A was extended to Jammu and Kashmir through a Constitutional Order in 1954. The significance of Article 35A is that it helps the State to retain a distinct character in terms of its residents. It actually protects a law that was passed by the Dogra monarch Maharaja Hari Singh during British rule to stop the influx of Punjabis into the State.

Option (A) would have been appropriate at the beginning of the paragraph; not at the end. Option (B) is apt for the blank. The exception with regard to the people of Gilgit-Baltistan adds strength to the vociferation for repealing Article 35A. Option (C) is a broader perspective of the issue. Option (D) is out of context. Choice (B)

A century ago, farmers in Bihar's Champaran district were forced to set aside 15% of their land to cultivate indigo under the Tinkathia system. Once planted, the farmers were still subjected to a variety of extortionist cesses, or abwabs. They rose in revolt but were crushed by the East India Company until the arrival of a barrister from South Africa. Yet, a century after Mahatma Gandhi fought against the exploitation of farmers, India's agrarian community still remains under siege. At the granular level, marginal farming in India is a highly complex and decision-intensive process. Farmers have to make a variety of decisions starting with the choice of crops (annual or short term) and their time of tillage. Then, there are rising prices of agricultural inputs, availability of water, soil suitability and pest management. _____

- ☒ a) This uncertainty gets reflected in rural debt levels. (Your answer - ✖)
- ☐ b) The writing is on the wall; India's small and marginal farmers will need another agricultural loan waiver.
- ☐ c) To mitigate the problem, greater subsidies need to be extended for the purchase of agricultural equipment, fertilizers and pesticides.
- ☐ d) All these factors create a narrow window of economic benefit for the marginal farmer. (Correct Answer - ✔)

Solution:

Option (A) tells of a specific 'uncertainty', not found in the preceding sentence. Similarly, a loan waiver,

stated in option (B) is not a panacea for the agricultural ills. Subsidy too, stated in option (C) is not a one-time solution. The 'factors' mentioned in option (D) apparently refer to the rising prices of agricultural inputs, availability of water, suitability of the soil and pest control. So, option (D) is appropriate for the blank. Choice (D)

Directions for questions 12 to 14: Four alternative summaries are given below each text.

Choose the option that best captures the essence of the text and indicate the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

While mining projects and water impounded behind dams are purported to be major culprits for human-induced earthquakes, unconventional oil and gas extraction practices that use hydraulic fracturing are now a frequent addition to the plethora of human disruptive activities. Any successful hydraulic fracturing operation induces micro-seismic activity because the rock is fractured. The number of successfully hydraulically fractured boreholes and the amount of associated micro-seismic activity seem to be ominously correlated. The more important trend is that hydraulically fractured boreholes and unusually large earthquakes are most likely related to the reactivation of preexisting geological faults.

1. Mining projects and water present behind dams add more severity to the already existing serious problem of seismic activity primarily caused by hydraulic drilling.
2. Hydraulic drilling for fossil fuel exploration, especially at sites with natural fractures in the crust, enhances the earthquake probability vastly.
3. Governments should identify oil exploration sites only after considering its geological structure so that the micro-seismic activity and usual seismic activity are not triggered.
4. Successful hydraulic fracturing results in oil and gas extraction on a higher scale, though this causes damage to the earth's crust, increasing the probability of earthquakes.

Solution:

The paragraph talks about hydraulic drilling and how it results in micro-seismic activity. When the fracturing is done at areas of pre-existing geological faults in the earth's crust, the danger of earthquakes is more severe. Option 2, which gives this sense is the best option.

Option 1: incorrect because the sentence implies that hydraulic drilling is the primary reason for the seismic activity. In fact, the first two are the major reasons and drilling adds more severity.

Option 2: correct as per the reasons given.

Option 3: incorrect because this sentence does not give the essence of the passage. In fact, this could have been a right option for a paragraph completion question.

Option 4: incorrect because the first half of the option, which talks about the quantity of gas and oil extraction is not justified by any piece of information given in the paragraph. Thus, the best option is Option 2.

Ans : (2)

Directions for questions 12 to 14: Four alternative summaries are given below each text.

Choose the option that best captures the essence of the text and indicate the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

Working at high altitudes can be excruciating. A throbbing head, aching lungs, confusion, fatigue and rapid pulse are all associated with hypoxia, a condition where tissues cannot get enough oxygen. It occurs when people accustomed to living at lower altitudes climb over 8,000 feet, and it can be dangerous and lead to pulmonary edema and even death. Nevertheless, people have successfully settled at these altitudes for almost 7000 years. When people are challenged by the environment, if some people have genetic traits that enable them to survive and reproduce more successfully than others who lack that trait, then those with the beneficial traits live and pass those traits along until it becomes more common in populations owing to the advantage it confers.

1. Life at high altitudes for people accustomed to lower altitudes can be very painful and demanding.
2. Genes and their adaptability play a significant role in survival and sustenance of life.
3. People who live at lower altitudes have a different genetic make-up for those who live at high altitudes.
4. Genetic refinements over generations enable people to survive and thrive at high altitudes.

Solution:

The paragraph introduces the problems faced by beings at high altitudes, and then answers the question of how they can survive in such conditions by genetic adaptation. Option 4, which gives this sense, is the best option.

Option 1: incorrect because this talks only about the first part of the paragraph.

Option 2: incorrect because this sentence ignores significant information of adaptations at high altitudes.

Option 3: incorrect because the essence of the passage is not about the comparison of genetic makeup of people living at different altitudes.

Option 4: correct as per the reasons given, is the best option.

Ans : (4)

Directions for questions 12 to 14: Four alternative summaries are given below each text.

Choose the option that best captures the essence of the text and indicate the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

Skeptical as it might sound, futurists, generally speaking, are hobbyists – they have the time for these theories because, in terms of wealth, they are already in the top 0.1 percent. They think of the future in large part as a way to invest their money and become even wealthier. They once worked in or still own Silicon Valley companies, venture capital firms, or hedge funds, and they learned to think of themselves as deeply clever – possibly even wise. They wax eloquent about meritocracy over expensive wine or their prohibitively expensive hobbies.

1. Hobbyists, who are affluent, are likely to be futurists who tend to serve self-interest rather than the universal causes.
2. Futurism is inevitably linked with capitalism.
3. Futurism can be criticized as a hypocritical cant of the affluent.
4. Another facet of hypocrisy is futurism.

Solution:

The overall tone of the passage towards futurists is negative. The paragraph says that these futurists, who are already rich, tend to own companies and, considering themselves clever, plan and argue for future. This sense is very indirectly given in Option 3, which is the best option.

Option 1: incorrect because if the passage says futurists are hobbyists, we cannot say hobbyists are futurists.

Option 2: incorrect because capitalistic tendencies are implied to be traits of futurists, but it is not purported to be the essential factor for futurism.

Option 3: correct as per the reasons given above.

Option 4: incorrect because of the wording. Had it been 'one facet of futurism is hypocrisy', then it would have been right.

Thus, the best option is Option 3.

Ans : (3)

Directions for question 15: The following sentence has a blank. From the given choices, pick the idiomatic expression that fits the blank appropriately.

No matter what concession India makes, Pakistan always seems _____.

- ☐ a) to break the ice
- ☐ b) to bring down the house

☒ c) to have a bone to pick with us (Your answer - ✓)

- ☐ d) to put us to the blush

Solution:

The idiom 'to have a bone to pick with' means to have some cause for quarrel and this is the appropriate idiom here. 'To break ice' means to commence a conversation where there has been an awkward silence. 'To bring down the house' means to call forth enthusiastic applause. 'To put someone to the blush' means to cause someone to redden with shame.

Choice (C)